Add an App to the Play Console

For the first step, you'll start by getting your app in Google Play, Android's equivalent of the App Store. To do that, you need a Play Console developer account.

Create a Play Console Developer Account

We'll follow the steps outlined in this Play Console help document.[65] Start by signing up for a Play Console developer account[66] with a Google account. You will need to verify both an email address and phone number and enable 2-step verification.

Then, visit the Play Console[67] and accept the terms and conditions. From there, follow the wizard to pay the one-time $25 fee and choose between an individual or organization account. Note that either option requires you to verify your identity *and* prove that you have a physical Android device. Identity verification is a manual process done by Google and can take a few days. You won't be able to publish apps, even for internal testing, until your account is verified. You're welcome to continue with the rest of the chapter while you wait. You'll be able to work through everything until the last section, *Distribute Builds to Testers*.

Create a New App in the Play Console

Create a new app by visiting the Play Console[68] and clicking Create app.

